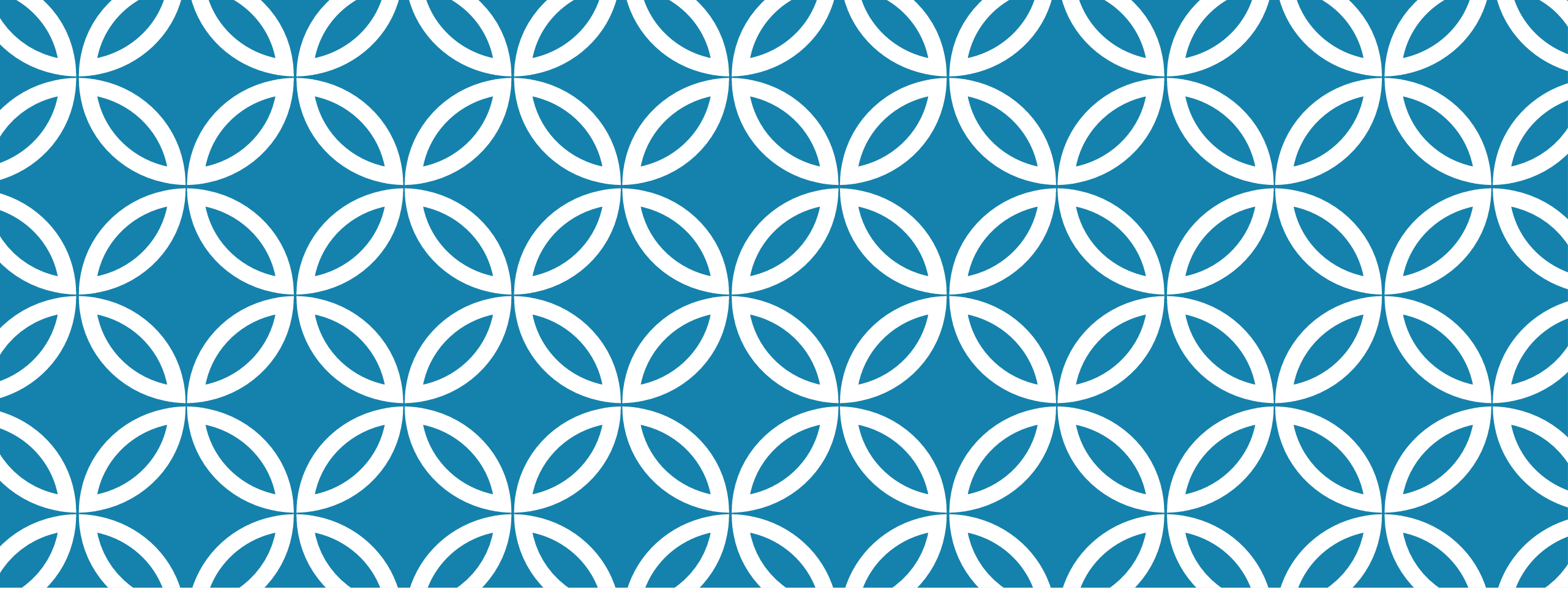
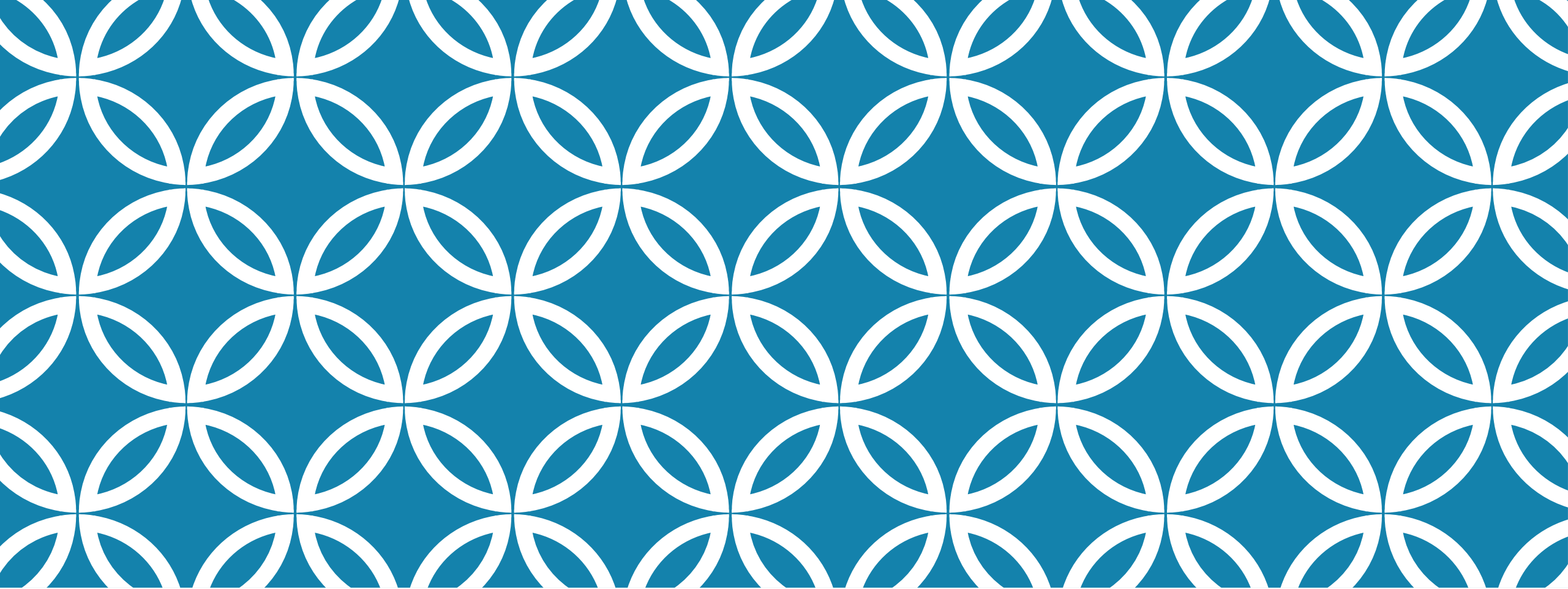




PUBP309: EDUCATION POLICY

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Indigenous Education in 19th
Century- Part II
Prof. Parimala Rao



THE INDIGENOUS EDUCATION IN INDIA:

PROF. PARIMALA RAO

**Access, Equity,
Curriculum, and the
British policies
towards them**

WHAT DO WE KNOW SO FAR?

There are a number of myths surrounding Pre – colonial Indigenous education in India

1. Teaching and learning was oral
2. All teachers/Gurus were Brahmins
3. Informal, Conducted under trees
4. Teachers were members of the village community and received remuneration in kind like potters or iron smiths
5. It was destroyed by the British

WRITING TRADITION

India has produced 500 core texts, 1 lakh inscriptions, 12 widely used script

How can an oral tradition create this?

496 texts were taught through manuscripts / 4 Vedas in oral tradition

1. Gurukulas – higher education – 12-14 + years Sanskrit
Pathasalas/tols – Sanskrit curriculum – sacred and secular-
Vedas-Dharmasastras-Ayurveda, Kalidasa
2. Lipisalas – Prakrit reading, writing, arithmetic – vernacular
pathasalas – Modern Indian Languages - reading, writing,
arithmetic

WHEN AND WHY THE DATA WAS COLLECTED?

The British parliament earmarked 100,000 rupees for the promotion of education in India / the Charter Act of 1813. British liberals had campaigned for it.

1. 1768-70 Famine - 3 million died. Modern education would help peasants to adopt modern technology in cultivation-. Education is best defense against natural calamities - peasants can better protect themselves from famines

2. Modern education would help people give up superstitious practices like sati, and female infanticide

3. Indians with modern education could have a say in the adm

The government of India opposed 'any interference in the internal affairs of Hindu society' did not spend money during 1813-1821 - Sanskrit Colleges - Calcutta, Poona

INDIGENOUS EDUCATION- DATA COLLECTION

Sanskrit scholars and scholars of Indian languages collected the data on the Indigenous schools 1819-1838 to make the government to invest in education / support indigenous schools / build modern institutions

We have data of over 16,000 indigenous schools that can be tabulated.

We have data of several districts that cannot be tabulated.

For instance, in 1824, Evantr Baillie, the Judge of North Konkan wrote that 380 boys in schools in Thana district came equally from 'Brahmin, Prabhu, Sutar, Bhandari and even coolies'

Without complete information, it is difficult to tabulate the data or prepare the tables.

THE EARLIEST DATA: RATNAGIRI DISTRICT 1819

Untouched by external influences

Thomas Best Jervis, a statistician Marathi scholar, was deputed to collect data on the number of villages, roads, rivers etc

He was interested in education, went to every school and collected information. So we have even the names of the teachers and caste of every teacher and student for this district

Jervis established the first teacher training institution in Ratnagiri in 1820 In Village Pent, Baji Pant Marathe - Brahmin teacher taught 1 Brahmin, 6 Sonar, 1 Shimpi, 10 Bhandari, 4 Sali, 3 Mali, 6 Khatri, 1 Panchal boys in a shed that belonged to a Teli.

In Village Palee, Amrutrao Bhagwant- Prabhu caste taught 5 Brahmin, 6 Prabhu, 7 Sonar, 5 Kasar, 4 Maratha, 5 Shimpi, 3 Surekuree, 1 Jangam, 3 Jew, 7 Muslim boys in the village temple. 46 boys this was the most popular school in the district

Teachers and Students in Ratnagiri District

1819- Thomas Best Jervis

Castes	Teachers	Students
Brahmin	33	567
Dominant castes - Prabhu, Vysya, Maratha, Lingayat	40	418
Artisanal castes, Kumbhar, Kansar/Kasar, Simpi, Sonar, Bhandari, Mali, Teli, Sutar, Navi, Koli, Panchal, Dhangar, etc	9	393
Total Hindu	82	1,378
Muslim	2	65
Jew	2	25
Total	86	1,468

STUDENTS IN GUJARATI AND KANNADA SPEAKING AREAS 1824

Districts	No of Schools	Brahmin	Dominant Castes- Wani, Kunbi, Rajput, Marwari, Jain, Lingayat etc.	Artisanal Caste-Sutar, Mali, Kasar etc	Muslim	Total	Average no of students per school
Veeragram (140 villages)	6	-	129	29	-	158	26.33
Ahmedabad (928 villages)	84	410	1,772	791	68	2,973	35.39
Dharwar	265	943	2,092	609	118	4,027	15.19
Belgaum	86	212	637	186	14	1,049	12.19

Castes of Teachers in Bengal, Bihar, Orissa

Castes of teachers	Murshidabad	Birbhum	Burdwan	South Bihar	Tirhoot	Total
Kayastha	39	256	369	278	77	1,019
Brahmin	14	86	107	-	1	208
Baidya/Vaidya	1	2	1	-	-	4
Kshatriya/Rajput/Aguri	4	3	30	-	-	37
Banik/ Vysya	1	10	8	1	2	22
Artisanal castes- Teli, Sonar, Tanti, Kurmi, Mali, Napit etc	4	43	104	5	-	118
Dalit castes - Sunri, Kalu, Chandal, Pasi	3	7	7	-	-	17
Total Hindu Teachers	66	407	626	284	80	1,463
Muslim	-	4	9	1	-	14
Total number of schools	66	411	635	285	80	1,470

Castes of Students in Bengal, Bihar, Orissa

Castes of Students	Murshidabad	Birbhum	Burdwan	South Bihar	Tirhut	Total
Kayastha	129	487	1,846	220	51	2,733
Brahmin	181	1,853	3,429	256	25	5,744
Baidya	14	71	125	-	-	210
Kshatriya Rajput, Aguri	38	148	969	189	86	1,430
Banik/Vysya	144	742	928	591	32	2,437
Artisanal castes, Sutar, Teli, Tanti, Napit, etc	479	2,270	4,361	1,466	299	8,875
Dalit castes- Sunri Kalu, Dom, Chandal	73	527	750	198	81	1,629
Total Hindu Students	1,058	6,098	12,408	2,920	574	23,058
Muslim	82	232	769	172	5	1260
Total	1,140	6,330	13,177	3,092	579	24,318

BENGAL, BIHAR, ORISSA

Teachers Total 1,470 teachers

Kayastha -1,019, Brahmin - 208 , Artisanal Castes - 118

Dalits- 17 (Murshidabad, Birbhum and Burdwan districts)

Students Total- 23,058

Brahmin 5,744, Non-Brahmins 15,685, Dalits- 1,629

Adam- 'parents of good caste do not hesitate to send their children to schools conducted by teachers of an inferior caste and even of a different religion. ... this is true of the Chandal, and other low caste teachers enumerated.'

Village Upper Bazar in Nattore, in Rajshahi district, Naba Kishore Das, a 32-year-old *Kaibarta* taught in a school established by Gobinda Pal, an upper-caste Mahajan/ Chandi Mantap

Bardaman District 1838

Untouchable Castes	Indigenous Schools	Missionary Schools	Total
Kalu	174	33	207
Sunri	168	20	188
Bagdhi	117	21	138
Dom	58	3	61
Chandal	60	1	61
Jalia	28	-	28
Dhoba	19	5	24
Muchi	16	-	16
Hari	11	-	11
Tior	2	2	4
Lahari	3	-	3
Garar	2	-	2
Kahar	2	-	2
Mal	2	-	2
Maitya	1	-	1
Pasi	-	1	1
Total	663	86	749

MADRAS PRESIDENCY 1822 INDIGENOUS SCHOOL STUDENTS (KANNADA, MALAYALAM, ODIA, TELUGU, TAMIL)

No of Schools - 11,691

Brahmin- 30,479

Vysya -13,772

Shudra - 75,324

All other Castes - 22,794

Total Hindu students - 1,42,369

Non-Brahmin students - 1,11,890

Muslim - 10,864 (5% of total population)

Total -153,233

Number of Schools and Students in the Madras Presidency

Districts	No. of Schools	Brahmin	Vysya	Shudra	All other castes	Total Hindu boys	Muslim boys	Total	Average per school
Arcot N	630	698	630	4,856	538	6,722	552	7,274	11.54
Arcot S	875	997	370	7,938	862	10,167	252	10,419	11.90
Bellary	533	1185	981	2,998	1,174	6,338	243	6,581	12.22
Chengalpet	508	858	424	4,809	452	6,543	186	6,729	13.24
Coimbatore	763	918	289	6,379	226	7,812	312	8,124	10.64
Ganjam & Srikakulam	255	808	243	1,001	886	2,938	257	3,195	12.52
Guntur	574	3,089	1,578	1,923	775	7,365	257	7,622	13.27
Kadapa	494	1,416	1,713	1,775	647	5,551	341	5,892	11.92
Madras	305	358	789	3,056	313	4,516	143	4,659	15.27
Madura	844	1,186	1,119	7,247	2,977	12,529	1,147	13,676	16.20
Malabar	759	2,230	84	3,697	2,756	8,767	3,196	11,963	15.76
Masulipatanam	434	1,693	1,108	1,506	470	4,777	275	5,052	11.64
Nellore	804	2,466	1,641	2,407	432	6,946	617	7,563	9.40
Rajmundry	291	904	653	466	546	2,569	52	2,621	9.00
Selam	386	783	324	1,674	1,382	4,163	432	4,595	11.90
Srirangapatanam and Ganjam	41	48	23	298	158	527	86	613	14.95
Tanjore	884	3,180	222 + 369 K	10,661	2429	16,861	933	17,794	20.12
Tinnevelly	607	2,016	-	2,889	3,557	8,462	796	9,258	15.25
Tiruchirapalli	790	1,198	229	7,745	329	9,501	690	10,191	12.90
Vishakapattanam	914	4,448	983	1,999	1,885	9,315	97	9,412	10.29
Total	11,691	30,479	13,772	75,324	22,794	142,369	10,864	153,233	13.10

NWP/UP 1851

British adm - 8 districts-Agra, Aligarh, Bareilly, Etawah, Farrukabad, Mainpuri, Mathura and Shahjahanpur.

Mughal Emperor, the Nawab of Awadh, Rampur etc

These eight districts had 50 towns and 14,987 villages.

1,039 schools in these 50 towns, and 1,967 schools were scattered among 1,535 villages. Together they had 27,853 boys.

There were no schools in the remaining 12,987 villages.

Of the 21,342 Hindu boys, 6,614 were Brahmins, 10,429 non-Brahmin upper castes and 4,299 lower caste boys.

There were 5,491 Muslim students.

The Hindu teachers - 46.4% Kayasthas, 43.9 % Brahmin, 1.7 % Rajput, 1.8% Bania, and 6% artisanal castes.

ALL INDIA PATTERN VERNACULAR SCHOOLS

Vernacular Schools – 70-75% non-Brahmin students and teachers/ more than 35% were from artisanal caste/ OBC

Majority of teachers-Kayasth, Baidya, Lingayat, Pillai castes

Andhra and Gujarat majority of teachers were Brahmins

Brahmin students studying under non-Brahmin teachers was common.

Teaching was not hereditary occupation

Schools were conducted in Temples, Sheds, and houses of rich persons/
No dedicated school buildings

Average number of students per school normally varied between 8 - 25/
Konkan 2/ Kaira 150

In South India, many indigenous schools had girls-3,344 Hindu and 1,240 Muslim girls - co-education

SCHOOL TIMINGS

Schools worked for 12 hours, there were 2 breaks for morning and afternoon meals

The first session sunrise – 5/6 am till 9/10 am/ 1 hour break

The second session before 11 am to 2/3 pm/ 1 hour break

The third session before 3/4 pm to 6/7 / oil lamps

The schools functioned on the basis of lunar month of 30 days

The schools had holidays on Full moon, New moon, Ekadasi, Dwadashi as well as all important festivals Sankranti/Pongal, Ugadi, Deepavali

CURRICULUM

Books – Vernacular translations of *Ramayana, Mahabharata, Amara Kosha, Pancha Tantra, Hitopadesa*- Manuscripts

Bombay *Punchopaikyan* and *Vidhurniti* were taught in Marathi schools,
Karnataka, *Someshwara Shataka, Jaimini Bharata*
Madras Tirukural

‘Composition, grammar, literature, deciphering various handwritings, writing common letters, drawing up forms of agreements, *writing petitions/*

Arithmetic up to long division, - ‘cast up accounts and to draw out bill of exchange’, multiplication tables, village accounts

Gujarat- Arithmetic first

WRITING IN SCHOOLS

Writing was taught on the very first day at school

Sand boards- Plantain leaves- wooden boards- older students used hand made paper & palm leaves

A thick Calico cloth was dipped in rice starch and dried. It was dipped again in charcoal solution and dried. Soap stone cut into the shape of sticks were used to write on it.

Punishment was severe, caning was common

Fathers visited schools and monitored the progress / Mothers enquired the teachers about the progress of their sons

Children began the school 5-6 yrs/completed 13-14 yrs

Nobody failed, Bright children took 4 years, average children 6 years, below average 8 years to complete the course of instruction.

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**PALM LEAF – KANNADA
SUDHANVANA KALAGA**

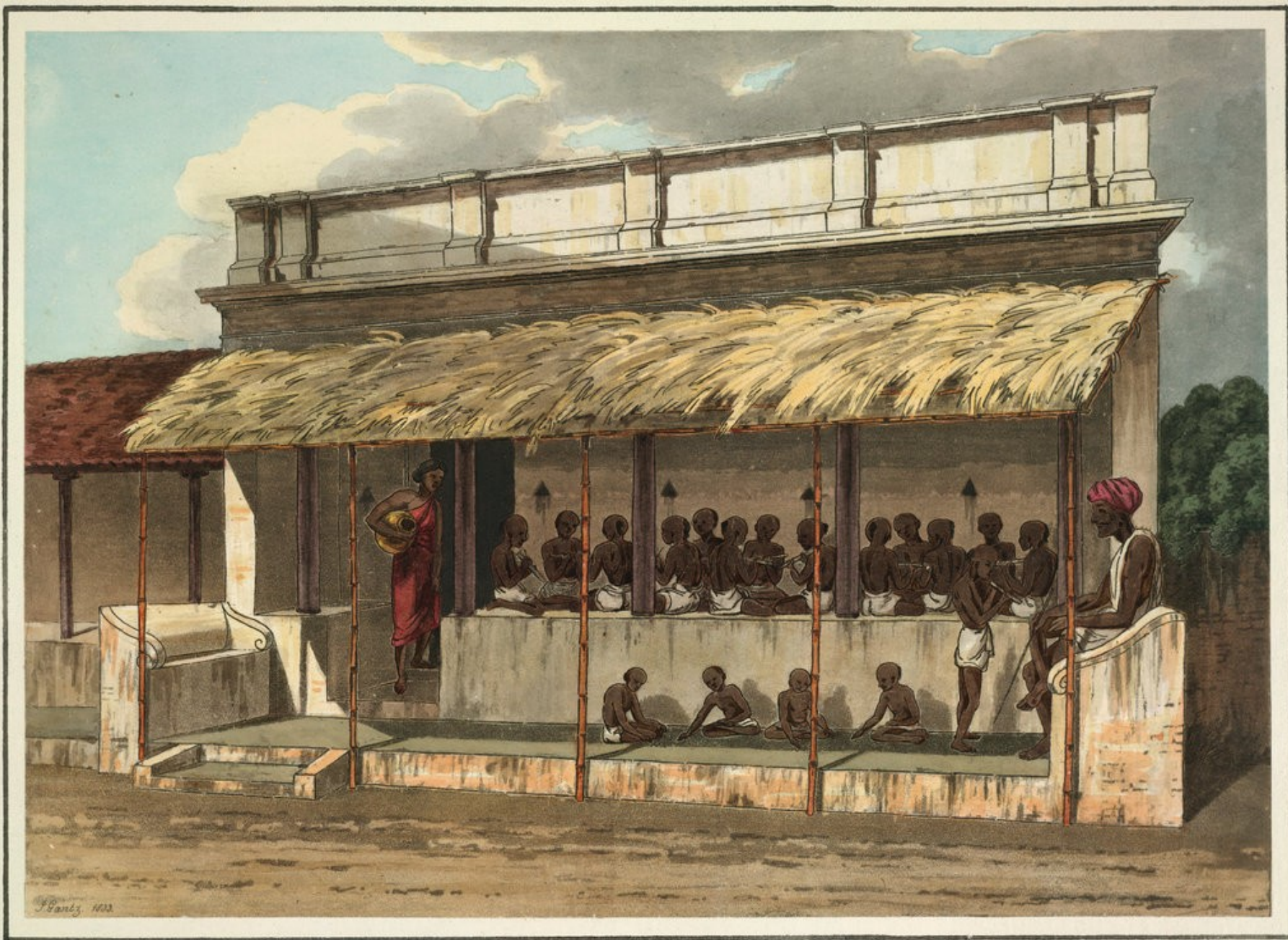
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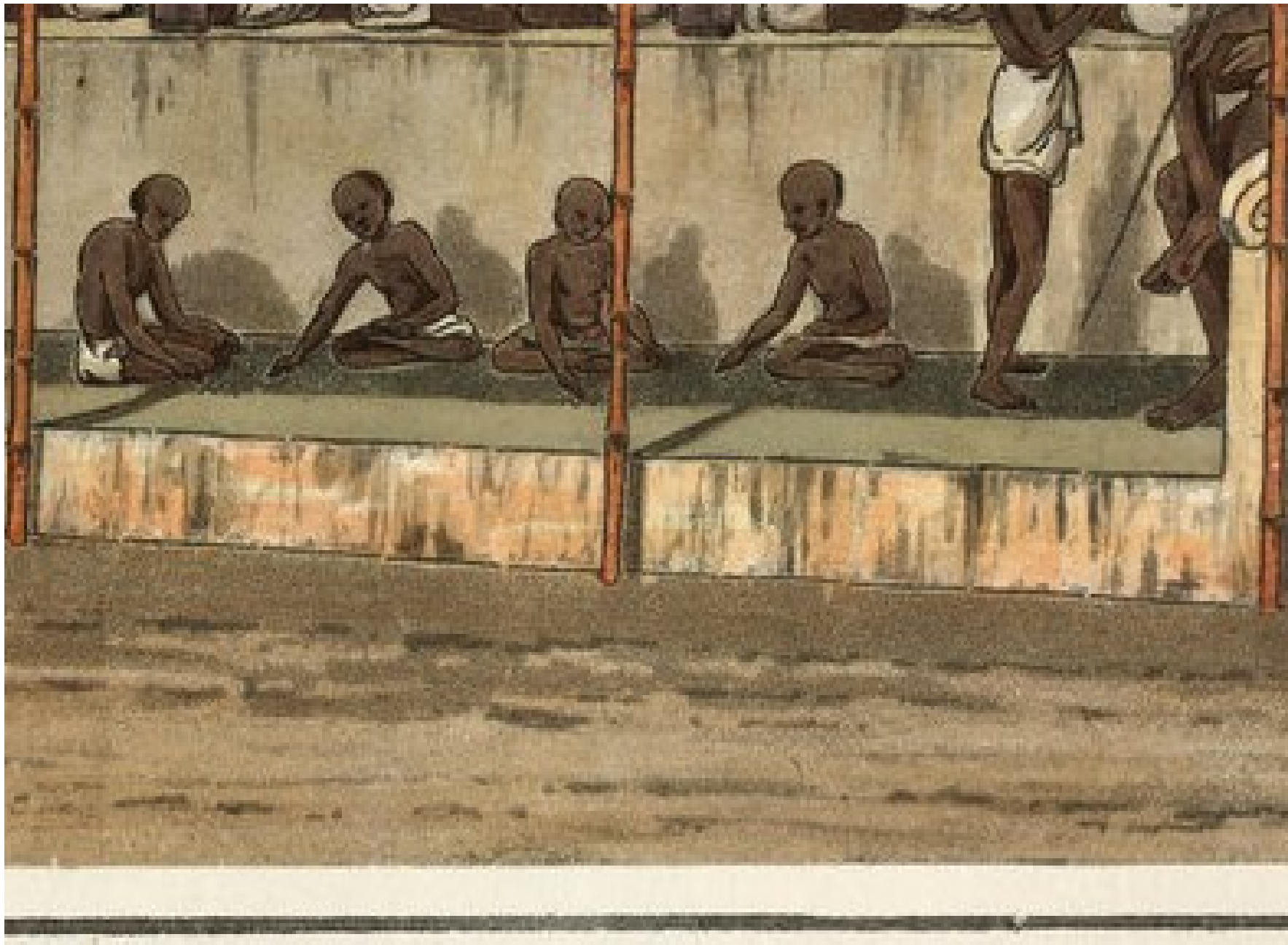
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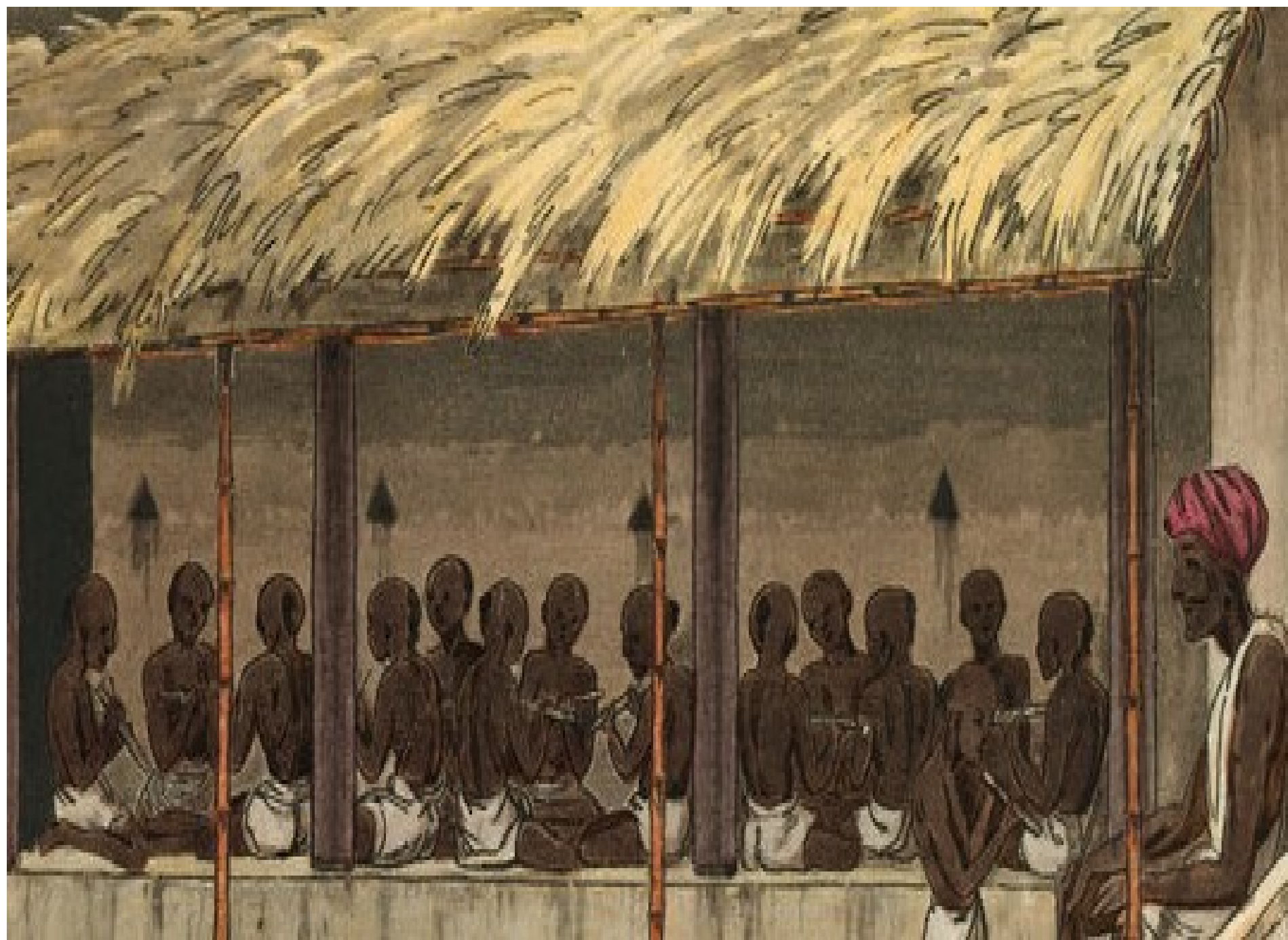


SOAP STONE STICKS BATTI/BALAPA/KHADI









INCOME OF TEACHERS-FEE IN CASH

Students paid anywhere between 1-8 annas a month as school fee

Lowest was in Talwandi in Punjab 1 rupee 2 annas

Bihar- 1 rupee 12 anna and 9 pisa a month

In Bengal it was 3 rupees 12 annas 3 pisa per month

In Bombay it was 6 rupees

Lahore and Kasur 7 rupee 8 anna to 8 rupee 8 anna

South India 6-8 rupees

Gujarat 2 rupees at every stage - large classes

Teachers received gifts Deepavali, marriages /local produce